INFORMATION TO KEEP WITH YOU

My complete treatment handbook

Vandetanib: RET-positive medullary thyroid cancer

Understand your treatment. Know what to expect. Keep your plan to hand.

Treatment pattern
Ongoing
Follow the prescribed daily plan

Treatment stages
1
Explained in the treatment reference

Regimen source
NCCP 00242
Version 6

> Once daily, continuously

Treatment stages

01 **Continuous oral treatment**
Once daily, continuously

Your team confirms the active stage and dates. The full treatment guide explains each step.

Inside your handbook

		PAGE
01	Understanding your treatment	2
02	Your schedule, tests and appointments	4
03	Symptoms and supportive care	11
04	Your record and contact card	16
05	Sources and further information	19

My name _____

Hospital / oncology team _____

Use the urgent instructions and contact numbers in your treatment guide. Your team must replace example numbers before patient use. Your individual treatment plan takes precedence.

CHAPTER 01

Understanding your treatment

IN THIS CHAPTER

Why this treatment is offered, what its medicines do, and how the agreed plan fits your care.

When to get help

Emergency: call 112 / 999

Severe breathing difficulty, collapse, seizure or severe chest pain: call emergency services. Do not wait for an online answer.

Contact your oncology service immediately

Temperature 37.5°C or higher, 36°C or lower, shivering or suddenly feeling unwell — even with a normal temperature. Call oncology urgently for fever, sudden illness, unusual bleeding, new breathlessness, persistent vomiting or inability to drink. Severe chest pain, severe breathing difficulty, collapse or a seizure: call 112/999.

Follow the urgent contact instructions from your treating hospital. If you cannot reach the team, seek urgent medical assessment. Outside clinic hours, use your instructed out-of-hours pathway or the emergency department.

This page does not diagnose symptoms or decide whether it is safe to stay at home. You do not need to know which medicine caused a symptom before calling.

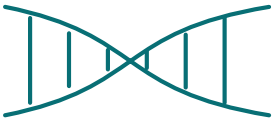
How the medicine works

This treatment aims to slow cancer growth and help control symptoms. Your team explains the expected benefit, uncertainty and alternatives for your situation.

KINASE INHIBITOR

Vandetanib

Oral targeted treatment



Blocks RET and other growth signals

Vandetanib blocks RET and other enzymes involved in cancer growth and blood-vessel development. It can also change the heart's electrical recovery, making electrocardiogram (ECG) and blood-salt monitoring essential.

RET signals blocked → Growth pathways interrupted → Cancer growth slowed

What to watch for

Carry the manufacturer's patient alert card and receive one with every prescription. Report fainting or palpitations urgently. Check every new medicine for heart-rhythm interactions. Diarrhoea can disturb blood salts and increase rhythm risk. Protect skin from sunlight.

The drawings are simplified explanations of drug action, not anatomical pictures or a prediction of response.

What the evidence can tell you

Research supports a treatment discussion; it cannot predict one person's outcome.

In the randomised placebo-controlled ZETA study, progression-free survival favoured vandetanib (hazard ratio 0.46; 95% CI 0.31–0.69). The vandetanib median had not been reached: 30.5 months was a statistical prediction, compared with an observed placebo median of 19.3 months. These values do not predict individual survival. Current RET-positive eligibility must be checked separately from the original study population.

CHAPTER 02

Your schedule, tests and appointments

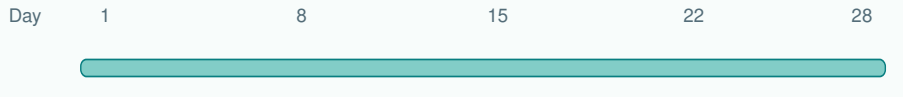
IN THIS CHAPTER

Your treatment stages, checks and practical preparations, from before treatment through follow-up.

Your treatment course

Vandetanib: RET-positive medullary thyroid cancer

28-day view



This shows treatment timing, not guaranteed symptom-free days. Your team confirms the active phase and dates.

ONCE DAILY, CONTINUOUSLY

Continuous oral treatment

Continue while helping and tolerated

Vandetanib 300 mg once daily, continuously, until progression or unacceptable side effects.

The team reviews the cancer, side effects and your preferences. Scans follow your individual treatment plan; this regimen does not set one universal scan interval.

BASELINE → TREATMENT → FOLLOW-UP

Your tests and treatment checks

Use the individual prescription and appointment calendar. No universal tumour-marker panel or scan interval is assumed.

The team arranges and reviews tests. This guide shows expected timing; it does not record completed appointments. NCCP 00242 v6: official regimen

Tests in your plan

Baseline bloods and tests

WHEN

Validated RET mutation test; full blood count, kidney and liver tests, potassium, calcium, magnesium, thyroid-stimulating hormone, ECG and blood pressure. Baseline calcitonin is additionally advised.

Checks organ safety and suitability before treatment.

Treatment safety monitoring

WHEN

Blood count, kidney and liver tests at weeks 1, 3, 6 and 12. ECG, potassium, calcium, magnesium and thyroid-stimulating hormone at weeks 1, 3, 6 and 12, then every 3 months for at least a year. Repeat this schedule after a QT-related reduction or interruption longer than 2 weeks. Continue checks after stopping when clinically indicated; monitor blood pressure.

Finds changes that may need supportive care, a dose hold or adjustment.

Specialist and cancer tests

If part of your plan

WHEN

RET is the treatment-selection test. Calcitonin is measured at baseline and later when clinically indicated to help assess medullary thyroid cancer. Thyroid-stimulating hormone measures hormone replacement needs.

Distinguishes treatment selection, hormone monitoring and cancer response.

THE WHOLE TREATMENT JOURNEY

Vandetanib: RET-positive medullary thyroid cancer: treatment and checks

RET mutation positive, unresectable locally advanced or metastatic medullary thyroid cancer.

Vandetanib 300 mg once daily, continuously, until progression or unacceptable side effects.

Read from left to right. Columns show stages, not equal lengths of time. This is a general plan: no dates or personal information are needed. Your team confirms which steps apply and arranges appointments.

Treatment, tests and reviews across the course

Care / check	Before starting	Early treatment	Ongoing checks	Dose hold / restart	After treatment
Blood and organ safety NCCP	Validated RET mutation test; full blood count, kidney and liver tests, potassium, calcium, magnesium, thyroid-stimulating hormone, ECG and blood pressure. Baseline calcitonin is additionally advised.	Blood count, kidney and liver tests at weeks 1, 3, 6 and 12. ECG, potassium, calcium, magnesium and thyroid-stimulating hormone at weeks 1, 3, 6 and 12, then every 3 months for at least a year. Repeat this schedule after a QT-related reduction or interruption longer than 2 weeks. Continue checks after stopping when clinically indicated; monitor blood pressure.	Extra tests may be needed for symptoms, dehydration or abnormal results.	Review results, recovery and previous toxicity before any restart or next dose.	The team reviews the cancer, side effects and your preferences. Scans follow your individual treatment plan; this regimen does not set one universal scan interval.

Care / check	Before starting	Early treatment	Ongoing checks	Dose hold / restart	After treatment
Appointments and medicines NCCP	Agree the treatment aim, dose and complete medicines list.	Take at the same time daily, with or without food. If a dose is missed, take it when remembered unless less than 12 hours remain before the next dose; then skip it. Never double a dose. If swallowing is difficult, disperse the whole tablet without crushing in half a glass of still drinking water, stir for about 10 minutes and drink immediately; rinse the glass with another half-glass and drink. Use no other liquid. Pharmacy must teach feeding-tube administration if needed.	Keep a current dose and symptom record.	Carry the manufacturer's patient alert card and receive one with every prescription. Report fainting or palpitations urgently. Check every new medicine for heart-rhythm interactions. Diarrhoea can disturb blood salts and increase rhythm risk. Protect skin from sunlight.	Keep follow-up and recovery checks even after the last dose.

Care / check	Before starting	Early treatment	Ongoing checks	Dose hold / restart	After treatment
Cancer-specific and specialist tests NCCP	RET is the treatment-selection test. Calcitonin is measured at baseline and later when clinically indicated to help assess medullary thyroid cancer. Thyroid-stimulating hormone measures hormone replacement needs.	Confirm the booked test dates with your team.	Safety tests and response tests have different purposes.	The team reviews the cancer, side effects and your preferences. Scans follow your individual treatment plan; this regimen does not set one universal scan interval.	Agree the named follow-up team and remaining checks.

What each check is for

1



Treatment and review

Once daily, continuously

This treatment aims to slow cancer growth and help control symptoms. Your team explains the expected benefit, uncertainty and alternatives for your situation.

Ask / act: Blood count, kidney and liver tests at weeks 1, 3, 6 and 12. ECG, potassium, calcium, magnesium and thyroid-stimulating hormone at weeks 1, 3, 6 and 12, then every 3 months for at least a year. Repeat this schedule after a QT-related reduction or interruption longer than 2 weeks. Continue checks after stopping when clinically indicated; monitor blood pressure.

At the next review, ask

- Which treatment phase am I in, and what happens next?
- Which test is expected next, who arranges it, and who explains the result?
- Who should I contact if an expected appointment has not arrived?

This map does not show whether a test has been ordered, booked or completed. Do not wait for a scheduled test if you develop new symptoms.

Practical treatment planning

Agree the arrangements with your oncology team.

STEP 1

Before starting

Validated RET mutation test; full blood count, kidney and liver tests, potassium, calcium, magnesium, thyroid-stimulating hormone, ECG and blood pressure. Baseline calcitonin is additionally advised.

STEP 2

Taking or receiving treatment

Take at the same time daily, with or without food. If a dose is missed, take it when remembered unless less than 12 hours remain before the next dose; then skip it. Never double a dose. If swallowing is difficult, disperse the whole tablet without crushing in half a glass of still drinking water, stir for about 10 minutes and drink immediately; rinse the glass with another half-glass and drink. Use no other liquid. Pharmacy must teach feeding-tube administration if needed.

STEP 3

Tests and reviews

Blood count, kidney and liver tests at weeks 1, 3, 6 and 12. ECG, potassium, calcium, magnesium and thyroid-stimulating hormone at weeks 1, 3, 6 and 12, then every 3 months for at least a year. Repeat this schedule after a QT-related reduction or interruption longer than 2 weeks. Continue checks after stopping when clinically indicated; monitor blood pressure.

STEP 5

Leaving with a clear plan

Confirm the next appointment, dose, support medicines and verified daytime and out-of-hours phone numbers.

Your exact treatment schedule

Tests and preparation

CHAPTER 03

Symptoms and supportive care

IN THIS CHAPTER

Recognising changes, knowing when to call, and using your prescribed supportive-care plan.

Your continuous-treatment review window.

Timing is a general guide; symptoms may start or stop at other times.

Treatment or check	Timing in this view
Vandetanib every day	 **Days 1–28** Vandetanib 300 mg once daily, continuously, until progression or unacceptable side effects.

This 28-day window is a review calendar, not a rest cycle or a fixed treatment duration.

Treatment continues daily across review dates unless your team tells you to hold or stop. No automatic rest week is scheduled.

> Use your treating service's written temperature threshold and urgent-contact plan. Fever, shivering or sudden illness can be serious even without a high temperature. Do not wait for the next visit. Severe chest pain, severe breathing difficulty, collapse or a seizure needs emergency help: call 112 or 999.

Read the whole review window as text

Day 1–28: Every day, including weekends

Take at the same time daily, with or without food. If a dose is missed, take it when remembered unless less than 12 hours remain before the next dose; then skip it. Never double a dose. If swallowing is difficult, disperse the whole tablet without crushing in half a glass of still drinking water, stir for about 10 minutes and drink immediately; rinse the glass with another half-glass and drink. Use no other liquid. Pharmacy must teach feeding-tube administration if needed. Follow your prescription. A hold or restart must be agreed with the team.

Support around the medicines

1 Preventing and treating sickness

This is minimal-to-low oral sickness risk; the team agrees rescue medicine if needed.

2 Medicine-specific support

3 Mouth care, nutrition and daily life

Follow the unit's mouth-care plan. Report pain, poor intake or weight loss early; ask for dietetic support. Pace activity, rest and work around symptoms.

4 **Medicine and interaction review**

Bring all prescription, non-prescription and herbal medicines. Check with the oncology pharmacist before starting or stopping anything.

Your diagnosis and treatment setting

Specialist tests

RET is the treatment-selection test. Calcitonin is measured at baseline and later when clinically indicated to help assess medullary thyroid cancer. Thyroid-stimulating hormone measures hormone replacement needs.

Treatment aims and choices

Review and alternatives

The team reviews the cancer, side effects and your preferences. Scans follow your individual treatment plan; this regimen does not set one universal scan interval. Discuss suitable alternatives, supportive care and the option of declining treatment.

Questions worth asking

undefined

undefined

undefined

undefined

undefined

undefined

undefined

undefined

Try explaining the plan back: Explain when you take or receive treatment.,Name the tests and next review date.,Show how to contact the team urgently.,Explain what to do if a dose is missed or treatment is held.

Supportive prescription draft for review. This is a regimen template. It is not an issued patient prescription; individual review and completion are required.

Continuous oral treatment

Active medicines: Vandetanib

Emetogenic risk: Minimal to low (oral)

Medicine	Dose / route	When
Antiemetic plan for current oral dose	Individual prescription	As agreed with oncology/pharmacy Review QT prolongation and all interactions; no automatic intravenous (IV) chemotherapy script.

Additional phase-specific support

- Take at the same time daily, with or without food. If a dose is missed, take it when remembered unless less than 12 hours remain before the next dose; then skip it. Never double a dose. If swallowing is difficult, disperse the whole tablet without crushing in half a glass of still drinking water, stir for about 10 minutes and drink immediately; rinse the glass with another half-glass and drink. Use no other liquid. Pharmacy must teach feeding-tube administration if needed.
- Blood count, kidney and liver tests at weeks 1, 3, 6 and 12. electrocardiogram (ECG), potassium, calcium, magnesium and thyroid-stimulating hormone at weeks 1, 3, 6 and 12, then every 3 months for at least a year. Repeat this schedule after a QT-related reduction or interruption longer than 2 weeks. Continue checks after stopping when clinically indicated; monitor blood pressure.
- Carry the manufacturer's patient alert card and receive one with every prescription. Report fainting or palpitations urgently. Check every new medicine for heart-rhythm interactions. Diarrhoea can disturb blood salts and increase rhythm risk. Protect skin from sunlight.

Before signing: verify allergies, current medicines, interactions, renal / hepatic function, QT risk, sedation, prior response, total steroid exposure and the rescue-medicine duration. Do not duplicate medicines from another phase.

Individual changes / rescue duration: _____
Prescriber / date: _____ Pharmacy review: _____

What to watch for

You do not need to know which medicine caused a symptom before calling.

1 Fatigue and neurological symptoms

Vandetanib

Balance activity and rest. Sudden confusion, seizure, severe headache or a change in vision needs urgent help.

2 Mouth, eating and swallowing

Vandetanib

Report ulcers, pain, dry mouth, difficulty swallowing or weight loss early. Ask for oral care, dietetic and swallowing support.

3 Heart and blood pressure

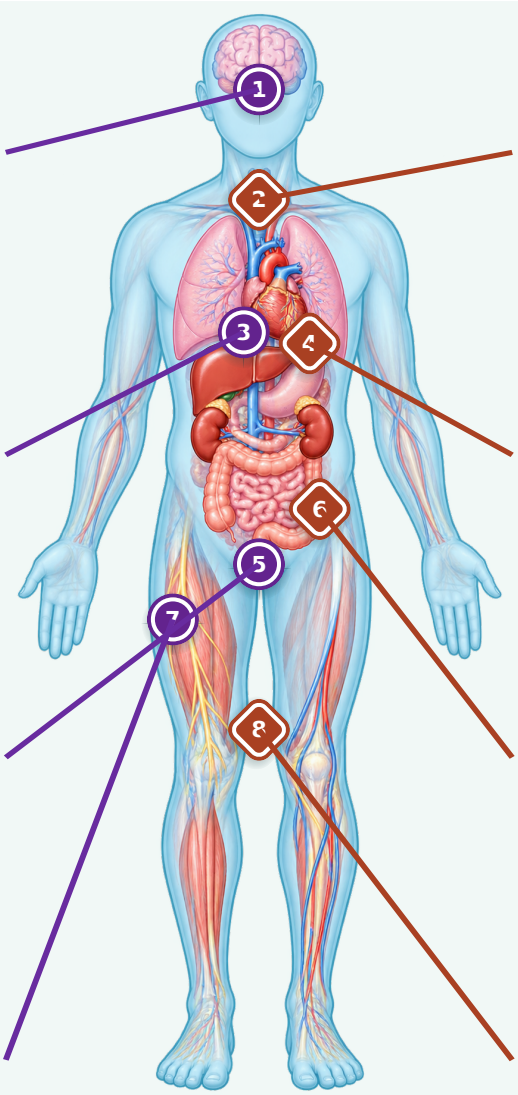
Vandetanib

Follow prescribed heart and blood-pressure checks. Chest pain, fainting, palpitations or new breathlessness needs urgent advice.

4 Breathing

Vandetanib

New cough or breathlessness needs prompt review; serious causes include infection or lung injury.



5 Sickness and bowels

Vandetanib

Use prescribed support. Report persistent diarrhoea or vomiting, inability to drink, blood or severe abdominal pain.

6 Kidneys and fluid balance

Vandetanib

Report reduced urine, swelling or poor fluid intake; keep blood and urine tests.

7 Skin, hands and feet

Vandetanib

Report painful palms or soles, rash or blistering early. Severe spreading rash or mouth/eye involvement needs urgent review.

8 Fertility and pregnancy

Vandetanib

Discuss fertility preservation, contraception, pregnancy and breastfeeding before starting.

Selected effects, not every possible effect or a prediction. Blood-count, skin and line markers are schematic. Number and text carry meaning; colour is decorative.

Call oncology urgently for fever, sudden illness, unusual bleeding, new breathlessness, persistent vomiting or inability to drink. Severe chest pain, severe breathing difficulty, collapse or a seizure: call 112/999.

When to get help

Call 112 / 999 for severe breathing difficulty, severe chest pain, collapse or a seizure.

Call oncology immediately: temperature 37.5°C or above, 36°C or below, shivering or suddenly feeling unwell, even with a normal temperature. Follow your hospital's temperature instructions. If you cannot reach the team, seek urgent medical assessment. Do not wait for the next appointment.

Oncology daytime: 087 12345678 · **Out of hours:** 087 87654321

EXAMPLE ONLY — team must replace both numbers before patient use.

CHAPTER 04

Your record and contact card

IN THIS CHAPTER

Space for your own cycle or review record, questions and notes, followed by your treatment card.

One review per page. Each medicine has its own symptom table. Mark the worst symptoms since your last review, when they occurred and what they stopped you doing. Overlapping symptoms can be recorded under more than one medicine; you do not have to identify the cause.

These are patient-language severity prompts, not a validated questionnaire or a formal Common Terminology Criteria for Adverse Events (CTCAE) grading tool. Your team assigns the clinical grade. Serious symptoms override the columns: call without waiting to decide a severity level.

Use a new record sheet for each cycle or review. Copy or print another sheet when needed; the number of sheets does not prescribe the length of treatment.

Cycle number: _____ Start date: _____ Next review: _____

Record each review; boxes do not imply a fixed course.

Vandetanib · copy this sheet for the next review.

Vandetanib · Kinase inhibitor

Symptom	None	Mild	Moderate / call	Severe / urgent	Emergency signs
Fatigue	□ Usual energy	□ Tiredness improves with rest	□ Rest does not help; usual tasks affected: call	□ Self-care difficult: urgent review	□ Collapse: 112/999
Nausea	□ None	□ Queasy but eating and drinking	□ Intake reduced: contact the team	□ Unable to maintain intake: urgent review	□ Collapse / severe dehydration: 112/999
Bowels	□ Usual pattern	□ New change: report	□ Persistent diarrhoea / constipation: call	□ Blood, severe pain or dehydration: urgent review	□ Collapse or severe sudden illness: 112/999
Skin	□ No change	□ New small change: report	□ Persistent rash / itch: contact team	□ Painful, spreading or blistering rash: urgent review	□ Severe skin reaction with acute illness: emergency help
Heart symptoms	□ None	□ New palpitations: contact team promptly	□ Palpitations with dizziness: urgent assessment	□ Chest pain or fainting: emergency assessment	□ Severe chest pain, collapse or breathing difficulty: 112/999

Dates / doses missed or changed / symptoms affecting daily life / questions:

Red flags override the table. Fever, shivers, suddenly unwell, chest symptoms or inability to drink: seek prompt advice. Severe breathing difficulty, collapse or severe chest pain: 112 / 999.

Keep your treatment details to hand

Medullary thyroid cancer · NCCP 00242 v6 · Document revised 14 November 2026

Print this page **one-sided on A4 at Actual size / 100%**. Cut only the dashed outer border around both panels. **Do not cut the centre line.** Fold with FRONT and BACK facing out, then glue or tape the blank backs together. Finished size: **85.6 × 54 mm**. Keep the stamp side writable.

FRONT / CONTACTS

My Treatment Card

SACTCheck

Name: _____

Vandetanib

Once daily, continuously

Phase: _____ Continuous treatment: team reviews dose

Daytime (EXAMPLE) 087 12345678

Out of hours (EXAMPLE) 087 87654321

Unwell or fever? Call oncology now.
Severe breathing difficulty, chest pain or collapse: **112 / 999.**

EXAMPLE NUMBERS — replace before patient use.

BACK / TREATMENT RECORD

My review record

Recording spaces only; not a fixed course.

Review	Date / initials

My treatment information

Latest review date: _____

Plan changed? Ask the team to update this card.

CUT outer border

FOLD centre — do not cut

Keep the record accurate

The team records each review and the current daily dose. Recording boxes do not imply a fixed course or a rest period. Record any held dose or changed plan. An entry does not authorise a restart; keep any medicine-specific alert card too.

Put your treatment page on your phone

Scan your QR and check the treatment name. Save that page to your home screen.

iPhone / Safari

Tap Share → Add to Home Screen. Select Open as Web App if offered, then Add.

Android / Chrome

Tap the three-dot menu → Add to Home screen or Install and create shortcut. Choose the shortcut option and confirm.

Menu wording varies. The QR opens information, not a personal record. Paper stamps do not update the website. Check that the saved icon opens the correct treatment.

Your local contacts and resources

Oncology daytime: 087 12345678 · **Out of hours:** 087 87654321

EXAMPLE ONLY — team must replace both numbers before patient use.

Hospital / team: _____

Backup if the team cannot be reached: _____

Additional local services and resources will be added when confirmed. Your team must check and complete this page before patient use.

SACTCheck v0.84.50 · NCCP 00242 v6 · Wallet-card sheet
Feasibility build. Clinical, pharmacy and patient/PPI review pending. Your team confirms your personal plan.

CHAPTER 05

Sources and further information

IN THIS CHAPTER

The references behind this information and addresses you can use to find further help.

Use this information alongside the plan agreed with your treatment team. Your team confirms your medicines, doses and appointments.

1. **National Cancer Control Programme (NCCP) 00242 v6: official regimen**
   https://healthservice.hse.ie/documents/6947/242_Vandetanib_monotherapy.pdf
2. **Caprelsa: EMA product information, including trial evidence**
   https://www.ema.europa.eu/en/documents/product-information/caprelsa-epar-product-information_en.pdf
3. **NCI: oral complications of cancer therapies, patient version**
   https://www.cancer.gov/about-cancer/treatment/side-effects/mouth-throat/oral-complications-pdq
4. **NCI: nutrition during cancer treatment**
   https://www.cancer.gov/about-cancer/treatment/side-effects/nutrition
5. **HSE: cancer treatment side effects**
   https://www.hse.ie/conditions/cancer/if-you-have-side-effects/
6. **NCCP supportive-care antiemetics for NCIS**
   https://healthservice.hse.ie/documents/7180/Supportive_Care_Antiemetics_for_inclusion_NCIS_Medical_Oncology.pdf